# HENRIK MARTIN SAUER

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## EDUCATION

**PhD Economics** *2023 – Present*
University of Mannheim, Germany
Essays on Financial and Competition Economics

**MRes Economics** *2021 – 2023*
University of Mannheim, Germany

**MSc Economics** *2020 – 2021*
London School of Economics and Political Science, United Kingdom

**BSc Economics** *2017 – 2020*
University of Mannheim, Germany

## RESEARCH

**Public Markets for Litigation Finance** (Job Market Paper) – *with Julian Klix*
We study emerging public markets for legal cases and how they affect financing decisions and settlement bargaining. We provide a theoretical model in which a risk-averse plaintiff sells a share of case proceeds to risk-averse and informed investors, and subsequently engages in bargaining with a defendant. In both public and private markets, financing induces a legal friction by reducing the plaintiff's exposure to trial risk, strengthening his bargaining position and making court trial more likely. Its strategic use induces a financial friction. The plaintiff anticipates the commitment benefit and sells more than efficient risk sharing would justify, which strengthens commitment and further enhances the legal friction. In public markets, prices add information but need not foster agreement. A sufficiently informative public price may in fact increase trial incidence relative to private financing and can induce the plaintiff to sell a larger share. An optimal regulatory cap maximizing the litigants' joint welfare is always binding below the efficient risk benchmark.

**Shareholder Reallocation around Merger Voting: A Common Ownership Perspective**
Recent theories on shareholder democracy predict that shareholders reallocate based on their preferences on the expected outcome of the vote. Taking a common ownership perspective, we investigate whether shareholders benefiting from a merger through their positions in industry competitors increase their ownership before an approval vote, and vice versa. Leveraging a regression discontinuity design, we find that hedge funds and mutual funds increase their ownership in the acquirer by 0.6 pp per $100M in combined abnormal returns to horizontal competitors. With such trading, shareholder approval becomes disconnected from the acquirer's gains and thereby systematically less informative to competition authorities. Moreover, we document vote avoidance behavior among managers whose active owners are also exposed to competitors.

**Loss-Portfolio-Transfers in Reinsurance Markets**
Work in progress

## INTERESTS

Financial Economics, Industrial Organization
Microeconomic Theory, Applied Econometrics, Financial Intermediation

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**European Central Bank** *Starting 11/2026*
PhD Trainee – Market-based Finance Division

**Collaborative Research Center 224** *07/2024 – Present*
Project Member, B03: Consumer Protection and Competition Policy

**NERA Economic Consulting** *06/2022 – 09/2022*
Analyst Intern – Antitrust and Competition Economics, Berlin, Germany

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Economic Policy – 2023, 2025, 2026 (Undergraduate)
Principles of Economics – 2024 (Undergraduate)
Statistics I – 2019 (Undergraduate)
Analysis and Linear Algebra A – 2018 (Undergraduate)

## CONFERENCES

**2026**
MaCCI IO Day Mannheim, BCFM PhD Conference Cologne, EEA Congress Dublin, EALE Conference Warsaw, CRC-224 Retreat Bonn–Mannheim

**2025**
ENTER Jamboree Stockholm, CRC 224 Young Researchers Workshop Offenbach

## AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

Center for Doctoral Studies in Economics Scholarship, 2021–2023
Studienstiftung des deutschen Volkes (Top 0.5% of students), 2021
Deutschlandstipendium (Top 1.5% of students), 2020
Erasmus+ Mobility Grant, University of Warwick, 2019

## REFERENCES

**Volker Nocke**
University of Mannheim
Department of Economics
volker.nocke@gmail.com

**Ernst Maug**
University of Mannheim
Department of Finance
ernst.maug@uni-mannheim.de

**Ernst-Ludwig von Thadden**
University of Mannheim
Department of Economics
vthadden@uni-mannheim.de

## MISCELLANEOUS

**Programming & Tools**
Languages: Python (pandas, numpy, OpenAI, statsmodels), Stata, R, Mathematica, LaTeX

**Languages**
German (Native), English (C2), Spanish (B2), Latin (Latinum)

**Community Involvement**
Actor - ATG Mannheim e.V. (Co-Founder) in 2017-2019 and University Theater in 2023-2024